Affinity Diagram for Grocery Shopping App

Store Frustrations

- Transit & walking distance and time is the key determinant on where they shop
- Multi-store grocery run is accepted and even anticipated
- Frustrated with searching (online) between multiple stores for items
- Shops at same 2 places always for usually the same things every week
- Frustrated when seeing the items in-person and realize the quality is not good
- Frustration with stores out of stock in person
- Frustrated with stores not carrying all items on their list
- Does not want to vary routine or travel extra distance for a small discount on an item or two
- When grocery shopping is a burden they eat out (fast food)
- Relies on mental math instead of tracking total spending
- Deletes non-essential items when subtotal exceeds budget

Behavioral Constraints/Motivations

- Overwhelmed by people & new options (sticks to list)
- Finds keeping inventory time consuming & annoying (things go bad, things get thrown out, you forget to buy something)
- Little to no variation or willingness to change shopping behaviors
- Make trade-offs at checkout rather than during planning
- Does not check what is already at home before making a list
- Builds grocery list before checking store prices
- Budget limits decisions making more than meal planning goals
- Students rely on habits to reduce cognitive efforts during grocery planning

Demographic

- Enrolled in SNAP
- Part time job covers rent +bills = not money leftover for food
- Students that don't have cars
- International students, unfamiliar
- Low-income, no support to shop for necessities

Planning Grocery Trip

- Shops enough for the week because shared fridge space with roomates
- Distance & frequency
- Visualizing grocery list (Notes App, website, cart) is helpful/needed
- user be able to filter/order the list of stories based on their distance
- Manually compares price per pound between similar items
- Has a budget goal but no structured system to stay within it
- Users could make individual notes about each store which could only be viewed by themselves
- Plan shopping around the meal/recipe
- uses "meal-plan-first" grocery planning model
- Believes planning time can be significantly reduces
- Deletes non-essential items when subtotal exceeds budget
- Enjoys Trader Joe's recipe recommendations
- Does not proactively check weekly sales before shopping
- Buys the same staple items out of habit

Social Aspect: Roomates

- Animal Avatar as virtual representation
- Frustrated by overcrowded fridge & food waste due to roomates
- Roommates often buy same products, brands, items
- Food sharing (social app)

Quality & Brand

- Store preference is a huge factor
- Values brand heavily will go to multiple stores to get prefered brand
- Quality of food matters (organic, whole foods, cafe free, non-processed)
- Quality over price
- Display brands availale at each store when the user wants to expland the info about each item
- Make decisions based on lowest visible price not unit value → Scrolls repeatedly between similar items before choosing
- Brand loyalty (Trader Joes, Whole Food)
- Some people might seriously consider about food quality (freshness/taste) when buying groceries
- Info about latest restock for each item
- Student trade off brand loyalty when price difference becomes noticeable → Perceived quality influences purchase decisions even under tight budget constraints